TRF Guide for Tutors

Use when checking TRFs at the door and when grading. Total 50 points: Pre-Work 20 · Collaborative Inquiry 12 · Communication 8 · Closure 10.

Box	Pts	Strong answer	Think-aloud questions
Heading: Name, AVID Teacher, AVID Tutor, Date, AVID Period, Subject		Every line filled in, with the academic class as the subject.	Which class is this question from?
BEFORE · Topic / Essential Question from Academic Class		The topic or Essential Question from the student's class notes for this lesson.	What is the Essential Question or topic from your notes for this lesson?
BEFORE · Initial Question + Source	2	The exact question copied from the source, and the source written on the line (book and page, worksheet, quiz, or notes, with the problem number).	Where did this question come from? Can you say this question in your own words?
BEFORE · Key Academic Vocabulary and Definitions	4	Two key words connected to the topic or question, each with a definition (from notes, the textbook, or a glossary).	Which words do you need to understand to solve this? Where did you find the definition? Can you say it in your own words?
BEFORE · What I Know About My Question	4	Two things the student already knows that connect to the question.	What does this remind you of? What do you already know that connects to this? Can you predict a reasonable answer?
BEFORE · Critical Thinking 1: Show your thinking and identify the Point of Confusion	4	The student's actual work on the initial question, with the Point of Confusion marked. Symbols: ! = A-ha moment, ? = Point of Confusion, magnifying glass = need to research, ☺ = I'm confident about…	Show me the last step you're sure about. Where would you put the "?" on your work? Can you break the question into smaller parts?
BEFORE · Critical Thinking 2: General steps leading up to the Point of Confusion	4	The steps (math/science) or process (English/history) the student took, in order, up to where they got stuck.	What steps did you take first? Which step comes right before you got stuck? Have you done a similar problem? What steps did you use?
BEFORE · Tutorial Question (from the Point of Confusion)	2	An authentic, specific question about the Point of Confusion that is DIFFERENT from the initial question. Not "I don't get it."	What exactly is the step you can't do? How is this question different from your initial question? Can you use one of your vocabulary words in it?
DURING · Collaborative Inquiry	12	Check all that apply: uses Socratic questioning; utilizes resources to investigate the student presenter's POC; takes focused notes (Phase 1) or supplements academic class notes (Phases 2–3).	What question could you ask the presenter to dig deeper? Which resource (notes, textbook) could help the presenter here?
DURING · Communication	8	Check all that apply: communicates clearly, both verbally and nonverbally; listens effectively to decipher meaning; demonstrates command of academic vocabulary; adapts speech to an academic setting.	Can you say that again using the academic vocabulary word? What did the presenter just say? Can you put it in your own words?
AFTER · Closure	10	Check all that apply: summarizes key academic learning points; reflects on today's tutorial process and identifies next steps.	What is the most important thing you learned today? What will you do next to keep working on this?

Vague vs. strong points of confusion

I don't get number 5.	I can distribute in $3(x - 4) = 2x + 5$, but I don't understand how to get the x terms on the same side when there is an x on both sides.

I’m confused about photosynthesis.	I know photosynthesis makes glucose, but I don’t understand why plants also need cellular respiration if they already make their own food.
I don’t know how to write my essay.	I found two quotes for my claim, but I don’t know how to explain how the quote proves the character changed.

Adapted from the AVID Tutorial Guide training handouts for our tutors. Tutor Center · AVID